

KEY INFORMATION FOR LEARNERS

Overview of assessment tasks

Each task in this assessment brief has been developed to enable you to evidence achievement of the learning outcomes and Assessment Criteria for **CMI HTQ Unit 552: Managing Change**. Each of the Assessment Criteria must gain a pass outcome for you to successfully achieve the unit.

Preparation for the assessment

- Please read the **CMI HTQ Unit 552: Managing Change** specification thoroughly as only the content related to the achievement of the Assessment Criteria will be assessed.
- Research the topics being assessed. Suggested reading/web resources are provided in the **CMI HTQ Unit 552: Managing Change** specification. Your tutor may signpost you to relevant resources. Additionally, you may access excellent online resources at ManagementDirect <https://members.md.cmi.org.uk>
- Please read the definitions of the command verbs used in the Assessment Criteria (e.g. evaluate, discuss, analyse) at <https://www.managers.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/Command-Verb-Definitions.pdf>

Completing the assessment brief

- The assessment brief contains a series of tasks which are clearly referenced to the relevant Assessment Criteria.
- Refer to the Assessment Guidance Table at the end of the assessment brief which outlines the requirements for a Pass or Refer.
- Evidence for assessment must be presented in the Assessment Booklet or other suitable format.
- If work based evidence is used, such as plans or documentation (which has been referred to within the main text, it should be included in the 'Work Based Evidence' section in the Assessment Booklet
- Appendices are not a requirement of this assessment brief. If appendices are included these will not be marked or moderated by CMI.
- Work based evidence, where included, must not exceed SIX (6) pages. All evidence should be combined within the Assessment Booklet.
- Any assessment templates that have been created to support this unit are located in the Assessment Booklet.
- The Assessment Booklet must be completed in a professional manner (for example applying business conventions for writing formal reports) and by using Microsoft Word, Rich Text Format or another compatible software programme.
- The Assessment Booklet must be saved as a word document (.doc or .docx) and not in a PDF format.
- An appropriate referencing system (such as Harvard Referencing) must be used to ensure the original source(s) of quotations or models can be verified. Please refer to Reference and Citations Study guide at <https://www.managers.org.uk/~media/Files/PDF/Study%20Support/References-and-Citations.pdf>
- Finally, you must complete and sign the Learner Statement of Authenticity (an electronic signature is accepted)

Learner support

For information regarding policies and procedures for assessment (for example reasonable adjustments, learner support, appeals, complaints, certification, confidentiality, plagiarism) you should contact your tutor or Centre manager and refer to the CMI Level 5 Diploma in Operational Management syllabus.

ASSESSMENT BRIEF: HTQ UNIT 552 - MANAGING CHANGE

Assessment brief CMI HTQ Unit 552 has been designed to facilitate learners in demonstrating their proficiency in managing change within an organisation. This unit will enable the learner to evaluate types of change and reasons for change within organisations and enable the learner to select and apply theoretical models for the management of change. The purpose is not only to enable learners to develop the skills to manage change and achieve set objectives, but to do so in a professional manner with open and honest communication throughout the entire process.

ASSESSMENT TASKS AND WORD COUNT

Assessment brief **CMI HTQ Unit 552** features the following assessment tasks. Further detail is provided against each assessment task within the brief.

Assessment Task		Learning outcomes covered by assessment method	Assessment Criteria	L5 ODM KSB	Guideline word count
1	Write a report titled: The reasons for change in organisations	LO1 Understand the reasons for change in organisations	1.1 Analyse the external factors which influence change in organisations	K4 K11 K12	Approx. 2000 words
			1.2 Analyse the internal factors that drive the need for change in organisations		
			1.3 Evaluate the use of theoretical models for managing change		
			1.4 Examine the potential impact of change in organisations		
2	Create a presentation on the different approaches to change management.	LO2 Understand approaches to change management	2.1 Outline the rationale for initiating change within an organisation	K4 S2 S11	No more than 10 slides - include all presentation notes - Approx. 1000 words
			2.2 Explore approaches to embed and sustain planned change in an organisation		
			2.3 Analyse the role of leadership in identifying and overcoming barriers to change		

			2.4 Identify reasons for engaging with stakeholders throughout the change management process		
3	Create a Proposal for managing a change within an organisation	LO3 Be able to initiate, plan and manage change in an organisation	3.1 Develop a plan for change within an organisation	K4 S2 S3 S9 S10 S11 S16 S17 S21 B1 B2 B4 B5	Approx. 3000 words
			3.2 Develop strategies for communicating planned change to stakeholders		
			3.3 Recommend practical methods to support individuals throughout the change management process		
			3.4 Identify tools for implementing and monitoring change		
			3.5 Recommend approaches to overcome risks and barriers to change		
			3.6 Analyse methods for measuring and monitoring the impact of planned change		

Guideline word count

The written word, whether generated and/or recorded, is expected to form the majority of assessable work produced by Learners at Level 5. The amount and volume of written work for this unit should be broadly comparable to a word count of **6000** words. This is to include a presentation, including notes, of no more than 10 slides (only the presentation notes will be included in the word count) within a margin of +/-10% for each. Excessive use of word count is not grounds for referral, however, the CMI reserves the right to return work to the Centre for editing and resubmission by the Learner.

The following are excluded from the written word count: Index or contents pages, headings and subheadings, diagrams, charts and graphs, bibliography, references.

If you require further guidance on assessment, please ask your centre to refer to [CMI's Quality Assurance Handbook](#).

UNDERSTANDING THE REASONS FOR CHANGE IN ORGANISATIONS

Change is inevitable if an organisation is to maintain competitiveness and currency of practice. This assessment has been designed to enable the learner to evaluate types of change and reasons for change such as the external and internal factors, to evaluate theoretical models for managing change, and examine the potential impact of change in organisations.

TASK 1

Write a **report** titled: 'The reasons for change in organisations'

The **report** should be in 4 (FOUR) parts:

1. **Analysing External Factors** (AC1.1):
 - a. Analyse the external factors that influence change in organisations. Identify and analyse at least **two** external factors exploring in depth how they impact organisational change. Provide examples to support your analysis.
2. **Analysing Internal Factors** (AC1.2):
 - a. Analyse the internal factors that drive the need for change in organisations. Identify and analyse at least **two** internal factors such as organisational culture, structure, leadership, or employee attitudes, and explain how they contribute to the need for change.
3. **Evaluating Theoretical Models** (AC1.3):
 - a. Evaluate the use of theoretical models for managing change in organisations. Choose two theoretical models and evaluate their strengths, weaknesses, and applicability to real-world organisational change scenarios.
4. **Examining Potential Impact** (AC1.4):
 - a. Examine the potential impact of change in organisations. Examine how organisational change can affect various stakeholders, this may include employees, managers, customers, and shareholders considering the potential benefits and challenges associated with implementing change initiatives.

Guidance for completion of Task 1

- *The report should include appropriate sub headings to organise the content. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate, but avoid over-reliance on these visual aids). Ensure all tables and diagrams are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.*
- *Your discussion should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks*
- *You may include good practice examples from an organisation you know well or have researched.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 2,000 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

UNDERSTAND APPROACHES TO CHANGE MANAGEMENT

Understanding approaches to change management and being able to initiate, plan, and manage change in an organisation are crucial for its growth, adaptability, and sustainability. By completing this task, the learner will gain a comprehensive understanding of different approaches to change management and develop practical skills for analysing, proposing, and communicating change initiatives within an organisation. They will be able to apply these skills and knowledge to effectively lead or contribute to change efforts in various organisational contexts.

TASK 2

Create a **presentation** to showcase your comprehension of approaches to change management. The presentation should be no more than 10 slides, and include comprehensive presentation notes. It is good practice that you ensure that there is alignment with the Assessment Criteria. Both the slides and notes must be submitted, however the word count will only apply to the notes with a margin of +/- 10% at the discretion of the learner.

Your presentation must address the following key areas:

1. Outline the rationale for initiating change within an organisation (AC2.1)

Provide a compelling rationale for why change is necessary within the organisation. Consider factors such as market trends, technological advancements, competitive pressures, or internal inefficiencies that necessitate change.

2. Explore approaches to embed and sustain planned change in an organisation (AC2.2)

Propose innovative approaches to embed and sustain planned change within the organisation. Consider strategies such as cultural transformation initiatives, employee engagement programs, or agile methodologies to ensure the change is embraced and integrated into the organisational culture.

3. Analyse the role of leadership in identifying and overcoming barriers to change (AC2.3)

Analyse the critical role of leadership in identifying and overcoming barriers to change. Explore strategies that leaders can employ to foster a supportive environment for change, create engagement with and ownership of the change, build trust and credibility, and effectively communicate the vision for change.

4. Identify reasons for engaging with stakeholders throughout the change management process (AC2.4)

Identify the importance of engaging with stakeholders throughout the change management process. Consider the diverse interests and perspectives of stakeholders, including employees, customers, suppliers, and community members, and propose strategies for effectively engaging and communicating with each group.

Guidance for completion of Task 2

- To evidence this presentation, you must include comprehensive presentation notes. It is good practice to ensure alignment with the Assessment Criteria. Both the slides and notes must be submitted; however, the word count will only apply to the notes with a margin of +/-, create a **presentation** showcasing your comprehension of approaches to change management.
- Create a clear and logical structure for your presentation. Develop your content based on the objectives and structure outlined. Ensure that each slide contains relevant and meaningful information aligned with the Assessment Criteria.
- Use any relevant visuals as required such as images, charts, and graphs to enhance understanding and engagement. Ensure all visual images are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.
- Include detailed presentation notes to accompany each slide. These notes should provide additional context, explanation, and talking points for the presenter. Presentation notes should be comprehensive but concise, helping you to articulate your points effectively during the presentation.
- Ensure that presentation notes are well-organised and easy to follow. Pay attention to the design and formatting of your slides. Use a consistent design theme throughout the presentation and choose legible fonts and colours that enhance readability. Avoid overcrowding slides with too much text or cluttered visuals.
- Use slide transitions and animations sparingly, focusing on enhancing rather than distracting from your message.
- Review your presentation thoroughly to ensure accuracy, clarity, and coherence. It is good practice to check for and correct any grammatical and spelling errors.
- The presentation should be no more than 10 slides, with a margin of +/- 10% at the discretion of the learner
- Ensure that your presentation is saved in a compatible format and can be easily accessed and viewed by CMI markers and moderators.
- Consider seeking feedback from peers or tutors to refine and improve your presentation before submission.
- Your presentation should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks. Remember to cite sources for any data or information used in your presentation.
- You may include good practice examples from an organisation you know well or have researched and are familiar with.
- Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.
- Word limit for presentation notes will be 1,000 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.

DEVELOPING A PROPOSAL FOR CHANGE

In today's dynamic business environment, organisations constantly face the need to adapt and evolve to remain competitive and responsive to market demands. Therefore, it is imperative for learners to understand the intricacies of change management and be proficient in devising effective strategies to initiate, implement, and sustain change within an organisation. These skills are essential for aspiring leaders and managers who are tasked with driving organisational transformation and ensuring its successful execution. Through this assessment, learners will not only enhance their understanding of change management principles but also develop practical competencies that are invaluable for their future roles within the organisation.

TASK 3

In this assessment, you will create a **Change Management Proposal** for an organisation undergoing a significant transformation. Your proposal should address various aspects of change management, including background context, objectives and scope, approach, implementation plan, communication strategies, stakeholder engagement, risk mitigation, and impact measurement.

The Proposal must address the following 6 areas:

1. Develop a Plan for Change

Create a detailed change management plan outlining the background context, purpose change, objectives, approach, steps, roles and responsibilities, timeline, and resources required for implementing the proposed changes within the organisation. (AC3.1)

2. Develop Strategies for Communicating Planned Change

Propose effective strategies for communicating the planned changes to various stakeholders, which may include employees, management, customers, suppliers, and other relevant parties and methods. (AC3.2)

3. Recommend Practical Methods to Support Individuals

Recommend practical methods and support mechanisms to assist individuals in coping with and adapting to the changes introduced by the organisation. (AC3.3)

4. Identify Tools for Implementing and Monitoring Change

Identify and justify tools and techniques that can be used to implement and monitor the progress of the change initiatives within the organisation. (AC3.4)

5. Recommend Approaches to Overcome Risks and Barriers

Recommend proactive approaches and strategies to overcome potential risks and barriers that may hinder the successful implementation of the change initiatives. (AC3.5)

6. Analyse Methods for Measuring and Monitoring Impact

Analyse various methods and metrics for measuring and monitoring the impact of the planned changes on the organisation, its stakeholders, and its performance. (AC3.6)

Guidance for completion of Task 3

- To evidence this plan, you are required to submit a **proposal** showcasing your comprehensive Change Management Plan.
- You must ensure that the report addresses all required components and demonstrates an understanding of project management principles and processes, aligned with the requirements of the Assessment Criteria
- Include supporting materials, such as communication plans, risk registers, and monitoring frameworks, as necessary. Ensure all support materials are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.
- Your proposal should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles.
- At level 5, learners are expected to demonstrate a basic understanding of academic research and critical thinking skills. They should be able to conduct literature reviews, gather and evaluate sources, and use evidence to support their arguments. Students are expected to demonstrate critical thinking by analysing information, identifying patterns or trends, and making logical conclusions.
- The proposal should include headings and subheadings as indicated. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate).
- Appendices will not be assessed.
- Your proposal should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks..
- You may include good practice examples from an organisation you know well or have researched and are familiar with.
- Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.
- Word limit will be 3,000 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes

ASSESSMENT GUIDANCE

Refer	Pass
• Not all Assessment Criteria have been met • No examples were used or the examples given do not match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Unclear • Technically incorrect or inaccurate • Biassed • Includes unprofessional language • Poorly structured and presented • Lacks sufficient detail to show understanding of the topic • The application of different theories or approaches is incorrect, unclear or inappropriate • Evidence is not directly attributable to the learner • Evidence of plagiarism, collusion, cheating • External sources of information are not acknowledged • Work based evidence does not meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are not current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)	• All Assessment Criteria have been met • Examples given are well chosen and match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Well written and presented • Contains a breadth of examples • Accurate • Current • Authentic • Inclusive • Coherent • Credible • Technically correct • Evidence shows understanding of different theories or approaches, is clear and appropriate • Evidence used from external sources has been correctly cited and referenced • Evidence is directly attributable to the learner • Work based evidence does meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)